OLIVIA ZHAO

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Academic Appointments

Faculty Fellow, Brown University — Providence, RI
School of Public Health (Dept. of Health Services, Policy & Practice) — 2026-2028

Education

Harvard University / Harvard Business School — Boston, MA
PhD Health Policy (Management) — 2026
Dissertation: "Economics of Prescription Drugs: Innovation, Payment, and Prescribing"
Advisors: Leemore Dafny, Mark Shepard, Leila Agha, Amitabh Chandra

University of Oxford — Oxford, UK
MPhil Economics, 2018 Marshall Scholarship — 2020

Massachusetts Institute of Technology — Cambridge, MA
BS Economics — 2018

Research Interests

Health economics, innovation, pharmaceutical industry, health policy

Publications

1. **Zhao O**, C San Soucie, DA Rauch, CL Cifra, L Lee, ND Beaulieu, D Cutler, and AT Chien. National Trends in Market Competition for Hospital-Based Pediatric Services: 2011-2018. *Health Services Research*. 2026;61(2). doi:10.1111/1475-6773.70102
2. San Soucie C, ND Beaulieu, JD Buxbaum, D Cutler, JK Leyenaar, SC McBride, **O Zhao**, and AT Chien. A National Analysis of General Pediatric Inpatient Unit Closures and Openings, 2011-2018. *Hospital Pediatrics*. 2024;14(11): 899–908. doi:10.1542/hpeds.2024-007754
3. **Zhao O** and AD Sinaiko. Effects of a Real-Time Information-Based Intervention on Physician Prescribing Behavior. *Academy of Management Proceedings*. 2024.
4. Vogel M, **O Zhao**, WB Feldman, A Chandra, AS Kesselheim, BN Rome. Cost of Exempting Sole Orphan Drugs From Medicare Negotiation. *JAMA Internal Medicine*. 2024;184(1):63-69. doi:10.1001/jamainternmed.2023.6293
5. Sinaiko AD, CE Sloan, MJ Soto, **O Zhao**, C Lin, FR Goss. Clinician Response to Patient Medication Prices Displayed in the Electronic Health Record. *JAMA Internal Medicine*. 2023;183(10):1172-75. doi:10.1001/jamainternmed.2023.3307

Working Papers and Work in Progress

- "Policy Incentives for Pharmaceutical Innovation: Evidence From Antibiotics," *with Edward Kong* (under review)
- "How Patient Assistance Programs Can Benefit Pharmaceutical Manufacturers and Employers: The Case of Copay Maximizers," *with Leemore Dafny*
- "What Happens When Drug Companies Can Cover Your Deductible?" *with Leemore Dafny, Lynn M. Hua, and Jinyeong Son*
- "The Doctor Will See Your Cost-Sharing Now: Price Transparency for Prescription Drugs," *with Anna D. Sinaiko*

Invited Seminars/Presentations and Awards

2026-2027	American Society of Health Economists (ASHEcon) Annual Conference, American Economic Association ASSA Annual Meeting (forthcoming)
2025-2026	ASHEcon Annual Conference, Southeastern Health Economics Study Group Conference, Cato Health Policy Workshop, NBER Productivity Seminar, Boston University Technology & Policy Research Initiative Seminar
2024-2025	Boston University Technology & Policy Research Initiative IP Day, ASHEcon Annual Conference, Academy of Management (AOM) Annual Meeting, ***AOM Health Care Management Division Best Paper Award:*** *"Effects of a Real-Time Information-Based Intervention on Physician Prescribing Behavior" with Anna D. Sinaiko*
2023-2024	ASHEcon Annual Conference, AcademyHealth Annual Research Meeting, NBER Productivity Seminar, INFORMS Healthcare Conference, Pediatric Academic Societies Annual Meeting

Professional Activities

- Ad hoc reviewer: *Journal of Health Economics, Health Affairs Scholar*
- Affiliations: American Society of Health Economists

Teaching

Essentials of the Profession, Health Policy (Section Leader, Harvard Medical School)	2023, 2025
Transforming Health Care Delivery (Teaching Fellow, Harvard Business School, Ariel Stern)	2024
U.S. Healthcare Industry and Regulatory Policy (Teaching Fellow, Harvard Kennedy School, Leemore Dafny) *Distinction in Student Teaching*	2022, 2023
Research in Global Health and Health Policy (Teaching Fellow, Harvard College, David Cutler)	2023
Analytic Frameworks for Public Policy (Teaching Fellow, Harvard Kennedy School, Richard Zeckhauser)	2021, 2022

Grants

Russell Sage Foundation Sheldon Danziger Pipeline Grant (under review)	2026

Selected Citations

- The Beacon, "Children's Mercy seeks massive expansion of its downtown campus…," April 2026.
- Congressional Budget Office, "How Changes to Funding for the NIH…," July 2025.

Other Activities

Brown University Fulbright Review Committee	2026-present
MIT Presidential Committee on Distinguished Fellowships	2021-2026
HBS Wyss Awards for Excellence in Mentoring Selection Committee	2022-2025
HBS Program for Research in Markets & Organizations (PRIMO) Advisor	2023

Miscellaneous

Health Policy PhD Program Joan P. Curhan Citizenship Award	2026
Citizenship: USA	